

INNOVATION AND EDUCATIONAL TECHNOLOGIES
GENERAL DIRECTORATE

LIFE IS MEANINGFUL WITH FRIENDS!

Course	English	Grade	8th Grade	Duration	4 lesson hours (4x40')

This scenario is designed to assist teachers in providing an effective learning experience utilising technology. The teacher may utilise this scenario, which is presented as an exemplar, or adapt it to align with the specific requirements of the students and the physical conditions of the educational institution.

Overview

This technology-enhanced learning scenario has been designed to develop the students' four language skills along with their digital skills. Thus, the scenario includes mind maps to teach personal traits, digital stories to exemplify making offers, structures used for accepting or refusing, and visual materials to teach the elements of an invitation card. In that sense, the teacher integrates innovative approaches designed to engage the students and foster collaborative learning. Therefore, the students are expected to be active, creative and productive, while the teacher assumes the role of facilitator. Through clear instructions and immediate feedback provided during the activities, the students can observe their own progress. As part of the evaluation process, the teacher creates multiple-choice exercises to be used for the game and designs matching activities. The students collaborate in groups to create a digital story on the theme of friendship using a digital story creation tool. Subsequently, they evaluate their peers' work using a group assessment rubric. The teacher provides ongoing feedback on all activities throughout the lessons.

Key Concepts: Friendship, Accepting or refusing an offer, Personal traits

Learning Goals

Students

- Identify the offers/suggestion/accepting/refusing structures in a listening text.
- Write a response letter to an invitation letter.
- Read and interpret the stories about friendship.
- Enhance their communication skills.
- Apply creativity to design a digital project.
- Work in collaboration for a project.
- Actively use target language and information technology.

Course Objectives

- E8.1.L1. Students will be able to understand the specific information in short conversations on everyday topics, such as accepting and refusing an offer/invitation, apologizing and making simple inquiries.
- E8.1.SI1. Students will be able to interact with reasonable ease in structured situations and short conversations involving accepting and refusing an offer/invitation, apologizing and making simple inquiries.
- E8.1.R1. Students will be able to understand short and simple texts about friendship.
- E8.1.R2. Students will be able to understand short and simple invitation letters, cards and e-mails.
- E8.1.W1. Students will be able to write a short and simple letter apologizing and giving reasons for not attending a party in response to an invitation.

Related Skills

- Communication
- Collaboration
- Creativity
- Digital skills
- Productivity
- Active listening
- Reading comprehension
- Critical thinking

PREPARATION

Learning Approaches, Methods, Strategies

- Cooperative learning
- Task-based learning
- Gamification
- Active learning

Tasks

Teacher

- Creates a digital story about friendship.
- Crafts an invitation card.
- Guides the students to work in collaboration.
- Encourages the students to take active role in learning.
- Motivates the students to use digital tools.
- Designs innovative activities.
- Fosters a flexible and motivating atmosphere for an active learning process.

Student

- Designs a digital story about friendship.
- Writes a response to an invitation card.
- Participates in the learning process actively.
- Works in collaboration with the group members.
- Joins in the activities to gain digital competence.
- Exhibits creativity in idea generation while fulfilling responsibilities effectively.

Instructional Tools/ Technologies

The web tools provided in this scenario are offered as examples. Teachers are free to select and apply any tool they see fit, according to the web tools category. It is recommended that teachers review the web tool in question before use and have a good understanding of the tool's interface.

Hardware

- Interactive whiteboard

Online Tools

- eba.gov.tr
- Mind mapping tools
- Visual creation and editing tools
- Digital story creation tools
- Web tools for matching activities
- Web tools for multiple-choice questions

APPLICATION

Activities

Before the Lesson

The teacher creates two mind maps: Good Personal Traits and Bad Personal Traits leveraging a mind mapping tool to stimulate engagement during the warm-up activity. Then the teacher creates a digital story titled Two Close Friends: Jane and Mary utilising a digital story creation tool to illustrate making suggestions/offers, accepting or refusing an offer (Annex-1). Lastly, to check reading comprehension, the teacher develops Multiple-Choice Questions using a web tool for multiple-choice questions (Annex-2).

Lesson 1 (IT Class)

Pre-Activity

The teacher writes "My Best Friend" on the board and says "My best friend is Büşra. I get on well with her because she is kind and thoughtful." Then the teacher asks the students to make groups of four. The teacher displays Good Personal Traits such as loyal, generous, helpful, caring and Bad Personal Traits such as jealous, sneaky, unreliable on the interactive whiteboard and wants the students to look at the mind maps and to form sentences to describe their friend. The students are invited to provide examples of either positive or negative personal traits. The teacher provides an illustrative example on the board to guide the students: "My best friend, Büşra, is very helpful and generous. She is a bit jealous, but I love her very much." Each group member considers the characteristics of their teammates and then presents their findings to the class.

While Activity

The teacher initiates the digital story titled Two Close Friends: Jane and Mary (Annex-1). Before starting to read the story, the teacher writes the structures of making suggestions/offers and the structures of accepting/refusing an offer on the board to remind the structures to the students. The teacher asks the students to take note of the structures they see in the story. The teacher informs the students that the multiple-choice questions are related to the story, so the students should follow the story carefully. While reading the story, in addition to the structures, the teacher emphasises the adjectives describing a friend. As the teacher narrates the story during its creation, the narration can also be repurposed for the listening activity.

Post-Activity

The teacher shares the link of Multiple-Choice Questions with the students and states that the activity will be in a game form (Annex-2). The student who provides the most accurate response will be declared the winner of the game. The teacher encourages the students to feel free to take an active role in the game and says"Good job!" when they find the correct answer. With the help of the gamification approach the students not only learn but also enjoy the learning process.

Related Skills: Digital skills, Communication, Active listening, Collaboration, Critical thinking

Before the Lesson

The teacher writes the cards with three good personal traits and three bad personal traits and shuffles the cards. Additionally, the teacher prepares a guideline for the digital story writing project and makes copies to distribute to the students (Annex-3). Lastly, the teacher prepares a group evaluation form for the digital story writing activity and makes copies for the groups and informs the students in advance (Annex-4).

Lesson 2 (IT Class)

Pre-Activity

The teacher prepares a set of cards, each displaying a positive personal trait and a negative personal trait. The cards are then shuffled and distributed to the students at random. The teacher asks the students to group with peers holding cards featuring the same adjective. In this way the class will be divided into six groups randomly and the curiosity about their groups will refresh the students before the planned activity.

While Activity

The teacher hands out the copies of the guideline for the digital story project and reminds the students how to use a digital story creation tool (Annex-3). The teacher asks the students to write a story about "Friendship" and not to forget to use both good and bad personal traits. Moreover, the teacher wants the students to make offers and accept or refuse the offers. In addition to incorporating visuals into their digital story, the students must record and add their own audio narration. In this way, both the creativity and the reading skills of the students will be improved. The teacher reminds the students that their performance will be evaluated by their group members so, each student needs to take an active role in creating the story (Annex-4).

Post-Activity

The students share the link of their digital stories on EBA and complete the group evaluation form.

Homework/Assignment

The students are assigned to read the stories on EBA and write comments for the stories.

Related Skills: Digital skills, Communication, Creativity, Productivity, Collaboration, Critical thinking

Before the Lesson

The teacher creates an Invitation Card with a visual creation tool, showcasing its essential components (Annex-5). Additionally, the teacher prepares a Matching Activity using a web tool for matching activities (Annex-6).

Lesson 3 (Class)

Pre-Activity

As a warm-up activity the teacher initiates "Four Corners of Me" activity. To tell the details of the activity, the teacher writes "Ann" in the middle of the whiteboard and after writing "Four Corners of Ann", draws four different boxes and writes four different details about Ann's life. For example, Ann' birthday, Ann's favourite food, Ann's favourite place, one thing positive about Ann's character. The teacher asks the students to take a piece of a paper and to write four corners of themselves. Once the four corners have been completed, the students exchange their answers with their classmates and engage in a discussion about them. Once the discussion has concluded, the teacher requests that the students keep their friend's birthday in mind.

While Activity

The teacher displays the Invitation Card for a birthday party (Annex-5). The teacher focuses on the necessary elements in an invitation card such as the event, the date/time, the place and the contact person. The teacher reads the invitation card in detail and to check the comprehension, asks the questions like "What is the event?", "When is the birthday party?", "Where is the birthday party?" and "Who is the contact person?" Then the teacher writes the questions on the board and asks the students to note these questions. Moreover, the teacher reminds the students that they will write a response to this invitation card in the next lesson.

Post-Activity

The teacher initiates a discussion on the Matching Activity to assess reading comprehension (Annex-6). Each student participates in pairs, taking turns to ask and answer questions. Then they proceed to the interactive whiteboard to match questions with answers.

Related Skills: Communication, Active listening, Collaboration, Reading Comprehension

Before the Lesson

The teacher shares the Invitation Card on EBA as the students will write a response to this invitation card (Annex-5).

Lesson 4 (IT Class)

Pre-Activity

To increase the energy and enthusiasm of the students, the teacher starts the lesson with "Three Truths and a Lie" activity. Each student writes their name and four personal traits (good or bad) on a piece of paper. Three true personal traits and one lie. Then the students walk around the classroom and find their pairs. The students show their paper to each other and try to guess which personal trait is a lie.

While Activity

The teacher revisits the Invitation Card, reviewing its elements to reinforce understanding among students (Annex-5). The teacher assigns the students to write a response to the invitation card by using a visual creation and editing tool. The students may accept or refuse the invitation. If the invitation is accepted, the students are expected to request further details in their response. Conversely, if the students refuse, they are required to provide a valid reason. When the students complete their writing task, they read their responses to the classmates and the teacher provides feedback to the students.

Post-Activity

To go over the making offers, accepting, and refusing structures and to determine the level of the students' comprehension, the teacher initiates Listening Exercise: New Friends on EBA. The students listen to the activity and then fill in the blanks with the appropriate structures.

Related Skills: Communication, Productivity, Digital skills, Collaboration, Creativity

Evaluation/Assessment Methods/Tools

- EBA + listening exercise
- Web tools for matching activities
- Web tools for multiple-choice questions
- Group evaluation form

REFERENCE

Related Links

This area is provided for the purpose of accessing the links included in the scenario. It is expected that the relevant links will have been checked and prepared prior to the commencement of the lesson.

1. Good Personal Traits: https://meb.ai/ltPrJi (Retrieved October 3, 2024)
2. Bad Personal Traits: https://meb.ai/Uv5bGAE (Retrieved October 3, 2024)
3. Two Close Friends: Jane and Mary: https://meb.ai/AqEEPY (Retrieved October 3, 2024)
4. Multiple-Choice Questions: https://meb.ai/rI843I (Retrieved June 30, 2025)
5. Invitation Card: https://meb.ai/U2X8QJE (Retrieved October 3, 2024)
6. Matching Activity: https://meb.ai/U32hvct (Retrieved October 3, 2024)
7. EBA-Listening Exercise: New Friends https://meb.ai/U86O3Ur (Retrieved October 3, 2024)

Sources

Canva. (2024). *Life is meaningful with friends!-invitation card*. Retrieved October 3, 2024, from https://www.canva.com/design/DAGSbUenKVE/iKc8zFhsD8u2ZUE8kmbvXw/view?utm_content=DAGSbUenKVE&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=uniquelinks&utlId=h8f0bbfe377

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Wayground. (2025). *Life is meaningful with friends!-multiple-choice questions*. Retrieved June 30, 2025, from https://wayground.com/admin/assessment/68623d2c5c84aac094d960a3?source=lesson_share

Visual Sources

You can access the visual source of this scenario by scanning the QR code

Attachments

Annex-1: The Transcript of 'Two Close Friends: Jane and Mary' Digital Story
Annex-2: Multiple-Choice Questions
Annex-3: The Guideline of Digital Story Creation Project
Annex-4: Group Evaluation Form (for Students)
Annex-5: A Sample Invitation Card
Annex-6: Matching Activity

The Transcript of 'Two Close Friends: Jane and Mary' Digital Story

Description: The teacher creates a digital story by using a digital story creation tool to exemplify some personal traits, making offers/accepting/refusing structures. The teacher provides a narrated version of the story to support the listening task.

Cover of the story: Attach a picture of two girls riding bikes in a forest and write the title of the story, Two Close Friends: Jane and Mary

First page: Attach a picture of a girl reading a book and two girls riding bikes and write these sentences: "Jane and Mary are very close friends. They like spending time together and they have lots of things in common. They are fond of reading books and riding a bike. They have a great time."

Second page: Attach a picture that symbolises the bond of friendship and conveys a sense of closeness and write these sentences: "They rely on each other as they keep their secrets. They support each other when they are in trouble. They never tell a lie. Trust is the most important thing for them.

Third page: Attach a picture of a party hat, balloons and a happy birthday post and write these sentences: "Their friend Tom is turning 14. He is throwing a birthday party on Sunday. Jane wants to go to the party with Mary, so she calls Mary.
Jane: Hello Mary! This is Jane speaking.
Mary: Hello Jane! How is it going?
Jane: Fine! Thank you. Would you like to go to Tom's party with me?
Mary: That sounds great! How about having a cup of coffee after the party?
Jane: That would be nice, but my cousin will visit me.

Fourth page: Attach a picture of three close friends having fun together and write these sentences:
Mary: I am sorry to hear that. Maybe next time.
Jane: Of course. See you on Sunday.
Jane and Mary go to the party and they have a great time. Jane and Mary think that they are very lucky to have such a buddy.

The End

Multiple-Choice Questions

Read the following questions and select the correct answer.



1. What do Mary and Jane do in their free time?

A) Dance
B) Read a book
C) Go to the cinema
D) Play volleyball

2. Do Mary and Jane have lots of things in common?

A) Yes, of course.
B) They don't have.
C) I don't know.
D) Maybe.

3. What they <u>never</u> do?

A) Ride a bike
B) Read a book
C) Tell a lie
D) Go to the party

4. Whose birthday is it?

A) Jane's
B) Kate's
C) Mary's
D) Tom's

5. Does Mary accept Jane's offer?

A) Yes, she does.
B) No, she does not.
C) I do not know.
D) Maybe.

6. Does Jane accept Mary's offer?

A) Yes, she does.
B) No, she does not.
C) I do not know.
D) Maybe.

7. What is Jane's excuse?

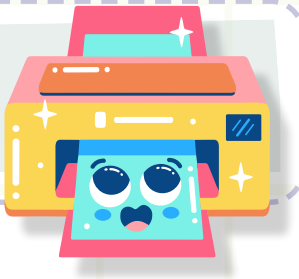
A) She will watch TV.
B) She will go shopping.
C) She will sleep.
D) Her cousin will come.

8. What is <u>the most important thing</u> in their relationship?

A) Books
B) Love
C) Money
D) Trust

The Guideline for Digital Story Creation Project

Dear students, this guideline is prepared to lead you while creating your story.



You will create a digital story about Friendship. You will use personal traits, making offer/accepting/refusing structures in your story then you will narrate your story.

Introduction:
Use a digital story creation tool to create a digital story.
Focus on personal traits, making offers/accepting and refusing structures.
Do not forget to narrate your story.
Share your story's link with your classmates on EBA.

Suggestions:
Try to use visuals in your story.
Be creative and productive.

Grading Criteria (Total: 100 Points):
Content (40 Points):
Creativity (20 Points):
Language use (20 Points):
Narration and pronunciation (20 Points):



Group Evaluation Form

Dear student, this form has been created to evaluate your teammates' performances. Please assign each teammate a score from one to five. Honesty is essential, as individual evaluations will remain confidential. You should complete a separate form for each teammate.



Improvable (1) **Acceptable (2)** **Sufficient (3)** **Good (4)** **Excellent (5)**

Your Name-Surname:

The Names of Your Teammates	CRITERIA			
	Collaboration & Communication	Taking Responsibility	Time Management	Creativity & Productivity

A Sample Invitation Card

Description: The teacher creates an invitation card using a visual creation and editing tool to illustrate the essential elements of invitation cards. The teacher adds visuals, such as a party cake and a “Happy Birthday” post, and writes sentences on the card, following the example.





Our friend Ann is turning 14 and we are planning a surprise party for her. Would you like to join our party?

Date: 10.10.2025

Time: 3 p.m.

Place: Daisy Café

Contact Person: Jeff Anderson- 123-45-67

Matching Activity

Description: The teacher creates a matching activity related to the invitation card by using a web tool for matching activities. The teacher writes five questions and their answers and asks the students to match the questions with the correct answers. To make the activity more challenging, the teacher adds three extra answers which are not related to questions.



Questions

1. What is the event?
2. Where is the event?
3. Who is the contact person?
4. When is the event?
5. What time is the event?

Extra Sentences:
It is at home.
It is a slumber party.
It is on the seventh of October.



Answers

a. It is at Daisy Café.
b. It is a birthday party.
c. It is on the tenth of October.
d. It is Jeff Anderson.
e. It is at three p.m.

Matches

1. b **2.** a **3.** d **4.** c **5.** e

Answer Key

Annex-2

1. B
2. A
3. C
4. D
5. A
6. B
7. D
8. D